

into an aithu's service, and if they are amenable, even other Thallain are as likely as any to keep their company.

Aithu prefer to avoid responsibility. They do everything they can to make sure they have to do as little as possible to remain comfortable, including using their hypnotic voices and stories to enthrall large groups of mortals just long enough to rob them all blind. In more spiteful moods, aithu can choose to create chimera that go along with their stories, using them to sow fear and discomfort in their listeners.

Appearance

Aithu are typically tall, muscular individuals with features that call to African and Middle-Eastern descent, but aithu of every race exist. They lean toward the sickly side of thin. In their fae mien, their smiles are just a bit too wide and conceal pointed teeth.

Endowments

Beguile: Aithu can enthrall a target with their enchanted voices. The aithu tells a story, and the Storyteller spends a point of Glamour and rolls Persuasion + Manipulation, resisted by the target's Willpower. For a number of hours equal to the aithu's successes, the target is haunted by visions from the aithu's story. While these visions can do no real harm, they are often a source of great mental distress (they might increase difficulties on Perception rolls or make a target unable to sleep; it's up to the Storyteller's discretion as to the exact effect). Eshu and oba are immune to this Endowment.

Pitiful Visage: Aithu may shift their appearance to a friendly old crone or lovely young paramour. The Storyteller spends a point of Glamour and rolls Appearance + Subterfuge (difficulty 7). This change lasts an hour per success. Seeing through the illusion requires a Perception + Kenning roll; if the player beats the aithu's successes, the changeling sees through the disguise.

Vulnerability

Spellbound: Aithu love listening to stories as much as telling them, and are even more easily enthralled by stories than mortals. In order to prevent being pulled into listening to one, they frequently interrupt, change the subject, or attempt to leave the conversation. If lulled into listening, the aithu offers the storyteller a token that can be exchanged for a favor. If the token is lost, so is the opportunity. Stories told by fellow aithu have no such effect, but they still clamor over each other when telling stories amongst themselves.

beasties

Glittering eyes, gnashing teeth, glistening scales, and gnarled knots of bone — these are the hallmarks of the beasties. Nasty creatures that survive on fear, Seelie fae or changelings often attack beasties on sight...provided they can recognize that they are Thallain. Even the fae mien of these nightmares is not so different from a changeling's, as only touches of their animal features mark them as inhuman.

The nightmarish cousins to pooka, beasties share the affinity for animals and shapeshifting. As with the pooka, they may shift into a secondary animal form. The animal forms of these Thallain aren't merely limited to creatures found in the Autumn world; they may be tied in some loose way to existing amphibians, reptiles, or mammals, but ultimately, the animal form of a beastie is a gruesome, twisted thing. It may have extra legs, be adorned with spikes, or secrete some nasty fluid from various orifices, but every aspect of it — functional or aesthetic — is aimed simply to terrify those that view it.

Seelie changelings have no love for these abhorrent creatures. As beasties are indifferent in who and what they will torture in the name of a game, many Kithain consider it a solemn duty to dispatch any they identify. Unseelie changelings are more willing to put up with their presence, but have no true love for them. Mortals that witness a beastie's monstrous form flee, driven to madness by the impossible sight of such a creature. When the Mists settle over them, most often the story is simply one of an attack by a large, possibly rabid, wild animal. The true memory of the beastie's appearance only comes again in nightmares.

The only true way to tell a beastie from an Unseelie pooka is by their call to the Hunt. This is the force that compels beasties to reveal their true selves: For one night a month, whole bands of beasties take on their animal forms and wreak havoc on the Autumn world, tormenting towns and people to their heart's desire. Unfortunately for their victims, these pranks are always dangerous, and most often prove to be fatal. Only when enough destruction and mayhem have been wrought do they slink back to their mortal forms.

Appearance

The wild calling of their true selves is difficult for beasties to lock away entirely. They have a more unkempt look about them; wrinkled clothes, unbrushed hair, and eyes that are always open just a bit too wide are some of the telltale signs. Even considering these factors, when a beastie is not actively Hunting, he can blend easily enough with Unseelie pooka. A Beastie's "animal" form is the stuff of pure madness and nightmares.

Endowments

Beastie Form: Like pooka, if no one is watching her, a beastie may spend a point of Glamour to shift into her true form. Shifting back has no cost, but must also be done alone.

Gaia's Mercy: The appearance and acts of a beastie when in their true form are concealed by the Mists within an hour.

Vulnerability

The Hunt: Once per month, a force calls all Beasties out to show their true selves and indulge in their cruel tastes and tendencies. If her true nature absolutely cannot be revealed, the beastie may attempt to sit the hunt out. The Storyteller must make a Willpower roll (difficulty 9). If successful, the beastie does not join the hunt, but is markedly more aggressive for the night.